



2024-25 Winter Term 2 UBC-V Individual Instructor Report for DSCI_V 310-101 - Reproducible and Trustworthy Workflows for Data Science (Daniel Chen)

Project Title: **2024-25 Winter Term 2 UBC-V Instructor SEI Surveys**

Course Audience: **68**
Responses Received: **31**
Response Ratio: **46%**

Report Comments

Recommended Minimum Response Rates

Class Size	Recommended Minimum Response Rates based on 80% confidence & ± 10% margin
< 10	75%
11 - 19	65%
20 - 34	55%
35 - 49	40%
50 - 74	35%
75 - 99	25%
100 - 149	20%
150 - 299	15%
300 - 499	10%
> 500	5%

Legend

N: Invited
n: Responded

Frequency Distribution
SD: Strongly Disagree

UBC Student Experience of Instruction

D: Disagree

N: Neutral

A: Agree

SA: Strongly Agree

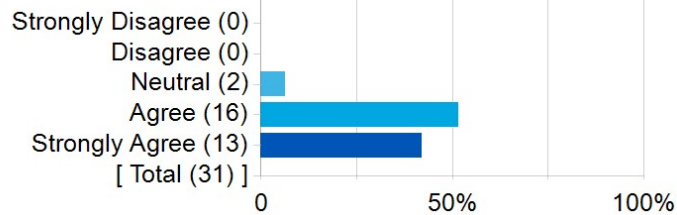
Creation Date: **Tuesday, May 6, 2025**

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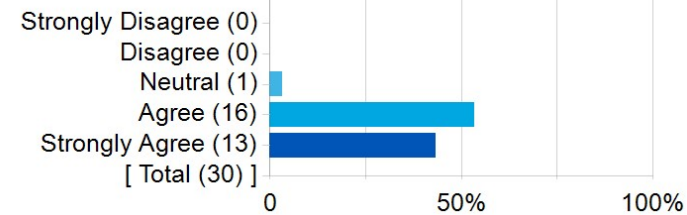
University Module Questions

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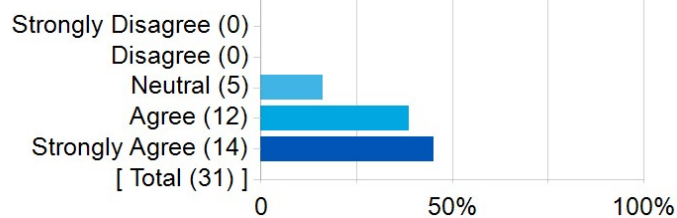
1. Throughout the term, the instructor explained course requirements so it was clear to me what I was expected to learn.



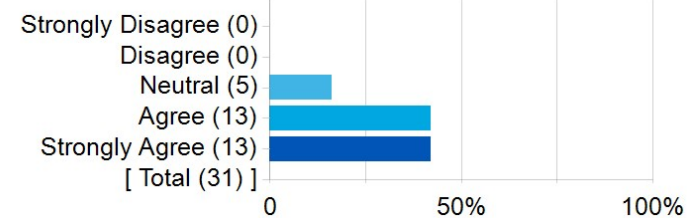
2. The instructor conducted this course in such a way that I was motivated to learn.



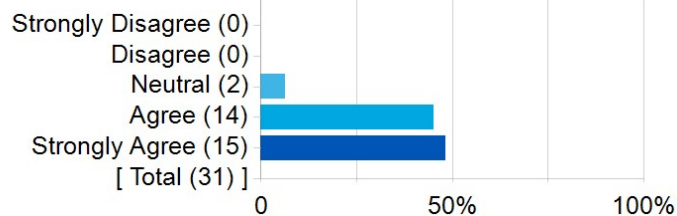
3. The instructor presented the course material in a way that I could understand.



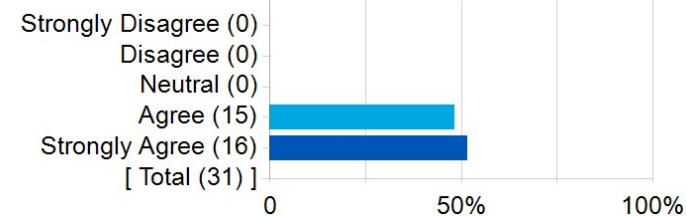
4. Considering the type of class (e.g., large lecture, seminar, studio), the instructor provided useful feedback that helped me understand how my learning progressed during this course.



5. The instructor showed genuine interest in supporting my learning throughout this course.



6. Overall, I learned a great deal from this instructor.



University Module Questions

Question	N	n	SD	D	N	A	SA	N/A	IM	PF	DI
Throughout the term, the instructor explained course requirements so it was clear to me what I was expected to learn.	68	31	0	0	2	16	13	0	4.3	94%	0.3
The instructor conducted this course in such a way that I was motivated to learn.	68	30	0	0	1	16	13	0	4.4	97%	0.3
The instructor presented the course material in a way that I could understand.	68	31	0	0	5	12	14	0	4.4	84%	0.4
Considering the type of class (e.g., large lecture, seminar, studio), the instructor provided useful feedback that helped me understand how my learning progressed during this course.	68	31	0	0	5	13	13	0	4.3	84%	0.4
The instructor showed genuine interest in supporting my learning throughout this course.	68	31	0	0	2	14	15	0	4.5	94%	0.3
Overall, I learned a great deal from this instructor.	68	31	0	0	0	15	16	0	4.5	100%	0.2

Faculty Questions

Course Questions

Question	N	n	SD	D	N	A	SA	N/A	IM	DI
My academic background provided sufficient preparation for this course.	68	31	0	0	3	15	13	0	4.3	0.3
In this class, I applied facts, theories, or methods to new problems or situations.	68	31	0	0	1	13	17	0	4.6	0.3

Question	%Favourable
My academic background provided sufficient preparation for this course.	90%
In this class, I applied facts, theories, or methods to new problems or situations.	97%

Instructor Questions

Question	N	n	SD	D	N	A	SA	N/A	IM	DI
The instructor treated students with respect.	68	31	0	0	0	4	27	0	4.9	0.1
The ways the instructor implemented the course activities (e.g., in-class activities, labs, tutorials, field trips, online components, assignments) helped me achieve the learning objectives.	68	31	0	0	0	11	20	0	4.7	0.2
The instructor was intentional about cultivating a welcoming and inclusive environment that supports all students and encourages all students to participate.	68	31	0	0	1	9	21	0	4.8	0.2

Question	%Favourable
The instructor treated students with respect.	100%
The ways the instructor implemented the course activities (e.g., in-class activities, labs, tutorials, field trips, online components, assignments) helped me achieve the learning objectives.	100%
The instructor was intentional about cultivating a welcoming and inclusive environment that supports all students and encourages all students to participate.	97%

Open ended feedback

Please comment on what your instructor did well to support your learning.

Comments
Accessible course material, including Github repositories for each class. Regular updates in Piazza. Tutorials and classwork are often heavily oriented to assisting in individual assignments and project milestones.
He did well in going over steps to steps for hard concepts.
Daniel was an enthusiastic and humorous . He is always eager to support the students and treats us with respect. He is a very fair instructor; I appreciated his good intensions.
Office hours are helpful!
Daniel was super accessible during the term, so while the classes felt very rushed he made sure to make up for this but making himself accessible to all questions
Professor was available all the time to help students individually. I felt like I could always get help.
Daniel always give clear explanation, patience help, and supportive resources, Great layout, great github community and content, loved it in general.
Having taken some CPSC courses that only glossed over the git content and some of the computer setup (e.g., python environments), I've always felt extremely unconfident and even uncomfortable about git and python because doing them always generated some sort of error. But in this course, Daniel really put effort in ensuring all of us are on the same page in the beginning of the semester (and throughout it as well!) The system setup page is super very detailed. I was recommending some other students I was working with outside of this class, talking to them about the terminal git commands. They actually wanted to read through the entire set up as a reference and even followed through the entire instruction guide to set/re-set up their computer for other collaborative projects, in addition to asking me about the git commands I learned from this course so they can use them on their own as well.
The textbook is also constantly being improved and re-engineered by Daniel beyond its already well-formed structure and content. Unfortunately I haven't been following along with the textbook as closely as I should, but it has been a reliable resource to fall back on. The instructor's Github repository demo has been incredibly useful as well. I was able to review them after class / while doing the project to make sure that I was on the right track.
Overall, I think the instructor structured the course coherently. The content itself is intrinsically practical, but it's unlike other 'practical' courses I've been in that would gloss over many details or conceptual bits. Instructor is alway readily available to student questions on Piazza forum and office hours, explaining ideas and notions with great patience and helping students to extend their interest in data science beyond the setting of just this class.
Daniel was super kind, helpful, and inspiring
Demonstrating material through examples in class
Engaging, thorough.
Professor Daniel Chen did an excellent job designing this course to emphasize real-world data science workflows. I really appreciated the hands-on structure — especially working with GitHub, Docker, Quarto, and reproducible pipelines — which made the concepts feel immediately applicable and relevant.
He was also very responsive on Piazza and provided clear explanations during office hours, which helped a lot when we ran into roadblocks.
Overall, I felt supported, motivated, and genuinely engaged throughout the term. This has been one of the most valuable and enjoyable courses I've taken during my degree.
Professor Daniel was incredibly kind and helpful. He was very knowledgeable about what he taught in the course, and was fairly lenient in grading. He communicated effectively whatever we needed to do about the course project, his lectures were greatly interesting.
Very engaging and hands-on lectures. A very useful course and the professor was very friendly and helpful.
Daniel is really helpful when explaining contents and fixing bugs for students. He's genuinely interested in supporting students.
He would always answer my questions patiently.

Comments
I liked how they were understanding of technical errors and spent a lot of time helping us debug our code.
I enjoyed how he did the demos in class. Most of my other courses that do live demos don't seem all that helpful but in this case, the professor was able to showing things step by step, which made it easier for me to understand what to do and what happens each time.
Always helpful on Piazza and after class
Great lecturer and great at explaining and demonstrating topics. The webpage that serves as the textbook is well organized and very clear. Very dedicated teacher, puts in great effort to help solve issues and explain answers.
Daniel was enthusiastic with his course content, and was extremely helpful in office hours, not only with coursework, but also in personal projects and job search related advice.

Do you have any suggestions for what the instructor could have done differently to further support your learning?

Comments
All good!
Daniel was a bit unorganized at times and talked very fast during lectures. Tutorials were not always clear, and sometimes I did not finish them even with TA support. In the future, Daniel may slow own when lecturing, especially during important parts. In addition, he should verbally describe each line of code that he is doing, as sometimes he would run commands without mentioning it and only show it quickly. As a student with poor vision (and attention span) I would miss intermediary steps and be lost for the rest of the class.
N/A
i think maybe course slides would help to structure the learning more to support students like me who get lost easily.
Some of the in-class lectures moved pretty fast and I would fall behind.
Maybe we should have mandatory tutorials instead of volunteer tutorials as these tutorials really does prepare for the milestone project. Also, may the lectures and syllabus page be more organized. Right now, the material of the course seemed to be every where, it is hard to catch-up once you skipped a class or two,
No
Be more clear on which sections of the textbook are being covered in each lecture
More readable notes on subjects. The course website in my opinion was sort of disorganized/disjointed and was hard to use to support my learning.
Overall, I really enjoyed this course and felt like I learned a lot — especially through the hands-on experience with tools like GitHub, Quarto, Docker, and Makefiles.
If anything, I think it would have been helpful to have a bit more walkthrough or examples for the CI/CD and testing sections, especially for those of us who are new to software engineering practices. These were some of the most unfamiliar parts, and having just one more class session or screencast demo might have made it a little less intimidating.
Better organization. He would often mix up the masters course and our undergrad course of what he had told us, and the assignments and such. He also would not reply to questions that quickly, and if you needed something you would often have to remind him multiple times. The assignments and project information was released at very inconsistent times. He is very helpful in person, just a bit better organization outside of the classroom would be helpful.
It would be helpful to slow down a bit when doing demos in class and upload all classes' terminal history after class.
the instruction on assigments (especially on Milestones) could be more detailed.
I think there are some cases where the professor doesn't cover everything in the book and we're expected to apply those in the project, which I found a bit challenging. I think it would be helpful to cover everything needed in the project during lectures.
No
Posted some of the assignments further in advance so we could get started. Different attribution of weight for the assignments. More weight can be given to individual assignments and the project. Participation grades could also be given for tutorials (full marks for effort). A considerable amount of work goes into each phase of the project and it is a very important opportunity to learn.
No, Daniel was one of the best professors I've had! I could tell that he cared about what he was teaching, and the advice he gave was very relevant.

Please identify what you consider to be the strengths of this course.

Comments
Accessible course material, including Github repositories for each class. Tutorials and classwork are often heavily oriented to assisting in individual assignments and project milestones.
Very practical course materials.
This course is useful and applicable for the real world. I enjoyed learning how to create a website using GitHub Pages and understanding how packages are made. Having the tutorials and assignments as precursors for midterms/finals were very useful and made me feel prepared for exams.
This course is probably the most useful course I have ever taken during my university career. I learned so much and can see its wide applicability as many of the topics that we discussed were things I wondered how to do correctly in classes I took before this.
I love how comprehensive the content was and wished I had learned this content earlier in my degree because it is so helpful for other classes and jobs.
Milestone Projects. Tutorial, Assignemtns, and Github Interactions with Teammates.
Very project focused! It's very hands on and practical. The whole course is designed in such a way that I think I can immediately translate all that I've learned here to my own project or in a lab setting.
The lectures, the tutorials
Preparing students to be comfortable using Github version control and project collaboration in the real world
One of the biggest strengths of this course is its strong emphasis on real-world, reproducible data science workflows. I really appreciated how we didn't just learn isolated skills, but instead practiced building full pipelines using GitHub, Docker, Quarto, Makefiles, and testing frameworks. This made everything feel much more applicable and relevant to real data science work.
The course also strongly encouraged team collaboration, code review, and clear documentation, which are often overlooked in academic settings but are so important in practice.
Lastly, the milestone structure helped break down the project into manageable parts and gave a strong sense of progression throughout the term.
Overall, the course gave me technical skills, but more importantly, it helped me think like a data scientist.
This has to be my favorite course this term, as everything that was taught in the course was of great help to me as I am trying to dive into the data job market right now. On the first day of class Prof Daniel said everything that this course teaches you will translate directly into the workplace, and I believe that is very true. Learning about basic software development tools like Github was very helpful, learning the importance and implementation of reproducible workflows was great. I wish there was a CPSC course that teaches this stuff. The midterm was perfect practice of the course material.
Very useful information! Nice lectures, and good resources online.
This course is practical and really helpful in real-life data project.
This course teaches students how to collaborate with tools of version control, and it fosters students'ability to work together as a group with correct workflow and attitude.
I liked how technical the course material was and how much application is done in the course; I feel like I will be able to use everything that I've learned in this course for work in labs, other courses, and jobs.
I found this course to be quite helpful in learning how to navigate git and how to collaborate with others. This would be more helpful if I took this course before my other dsci courses that required group collaboration on github.
Very useful content and up to date with modern tools
The content, this class explores important topics and the project is a great learning experience for data science projects. Daniel is also a great professor who shares his abundance of knowledge and experience about the covered topics.
Extremely useful. I believe the skills I learned in reproducible workflows will be incredibly useful for working with teams.

Please provide suggestions on how this course might be improved.

Comments
All good!
This course may benefit from improved organization. In particular, the tutorials may be revised for clarity. Also, the professor may need to set more time aside to address student concerns.
N/a
Please no 9am Friday tutorials. So brutal.
Maybe we should have a more organized content, or we should have projects division–task prior settled before making up a team. A lot of teammates did one–stop project which discourages others to work on the project.
I hope the tutorial time can be latter in the day haha. I do regret not attending them as often as I should because I just live quite far away from campus.
I really enjoyed this course and found it to be one of the most practical and useful classes I've taken.
Sometimes the information in lectures got a bit repetitive. I almost wonder if having a 3 hour lecture would be more useful, then you can teach all the concepts in one class without having to repeat yourself in multiple classes.
The syllabus and notes can be arranged in a way students can understand which class matches which course note. The current format is a bit confusing.
This course should be set as prerequisite for every science course that involves with collaborating with classmates on coding.
I spent a lot of time on assignments and the project and I feel like that time wasn't accurately reflected in the portion of our course grade that those assignments made up. The individual assignments in particular were time–consuming and quite helpful, but were worth so little that I didn't really want to put effort into them. The project took so much time that I felt like it should have been worth more of our final grade, but instead we had a 50% final, which kind of sucks for a course that is so heavily application–based.
I think this course can improve in showing what is being graded by the autograder so we can check things one by one, instead of waiting for the autograder results when we'd have to request for a regrade.
nothing to suggest
The weighting of assignments could be adjusted, the individual assignments are great tools to learn about the topics but 5 of them total 1%. The weights for each milestone could also be increased and weighted based. This would also help alleviate added stress to a lengthy final exam.
NA

Explanatory Note

The reported metrics are as follows:

1. Percent Favourable Rating

This is the percentage of respondents who responded with a 4 or 5 (Agree or Strongly Agree) on a scale of 1 to 5.

2. Interpolated Median

The data collected for Student Experience of Instruction (SEI) are ordinal in nature, with a natural order (from 1 to 5). The usual measure of central tendency for ordinal data is the median (50% percentile). The Interpolated Median (IM) is an adjusted median that considers the number of responses less than the median, greater than the median and equal to the median. As such, IM reflects the distribution of students’ responses.

Consider the following example:

Frequency Distribution		
Response for University Module Item	Section 1	Section 2
5 = Strongly agree	5	5
4 = Agree	3	5
3 = Neither agree nor disagree	6	0
2 = Disagree	1	2
1 = Strongly disagree	0	1
Mean	3.8	3.8
Median	4.0	4.0
Interpolated Median	3.7	4.2
Percent favourable rating	53%	77%

3. Dispersion Index

The dispersion Index is a measure of variability suitable for ordinal data (Rampichini, Grilli & Petrucci 2004). This dispersion index has values between zero and 1. A zero dispersion index indicates that all students in the section gave the same rating. An index value of 1.0 is obtained when the class splits evenly between the two extreme values (Strongly Disagree & Strongly Agree), a very rare occurrence. In SEI data at UBC, the index rarely exceeds 0.85, and mostly for evaluations not meeting the recommended minimum response rate.